Knowledge organiser (SUMMIT) — Refining technique through structured critique

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use criteria-led critique to test material refinements and resolve our final identity outcome?

Core studio focus

Family: Identity and studio log

Big question: How do we use criteria-led critique to test material refinements and resolve our final identity outcome?

• Audit your developing identity artwork against four summative criteria: Compositional balance, Tonal range, Edge precision, and Symbolic clarity.

• Conduct a structured peer critique to isolate one high-leverage technical refinement.

• Test the refinement on a live studio swatch before resolving the final identity piece.

Essential vocabulary

• criteria-led critique: Evaluating an artwork against specific technical benchmarks rather than personal opinion.

• high-leverage: A focused change to a key area (like the focal contour or core shadow) that lifts the whole artwork.

• value contrast: The visual punch created by placing your darkest dark next to your brightest light.

• resolution: Bringing all parts of an artwork to a purposeful, cohesive finish.

• synthesis: Combining insights from skill trials, practitioner analysis, and critique into the final piece.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Complete the four-criteria diagnostic: My critique partner and I score my identity piece against the four criteria and identify that the mid-tone pattern competes with my central motif.

Step 2: Run a 6 cm refinement swatch: On a scrap swatch card, I test glazing a translucent indigo wash over the background pattern while lifting the motif edge with opaque warm ochre.

Step 3: Resolve the final artwork and document: The swatch creates instant depth, so I apply the glaze and highlight rim to my final piece, then mount the swatch on my critique log.